



Curtin University

MFA *Instruction* Guide

2026



Before you start

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) adds an extra layer of security to your account.

During the log in process to canvas, you will be required to enter a six-digit code generated by an app on your phone. This ensures a second level of security across all of your canvas data. Canvas requires MFA for everyone, so the next few steps will guide you through setting it up using a free app called an “authenticator app”. You only need to do this once.

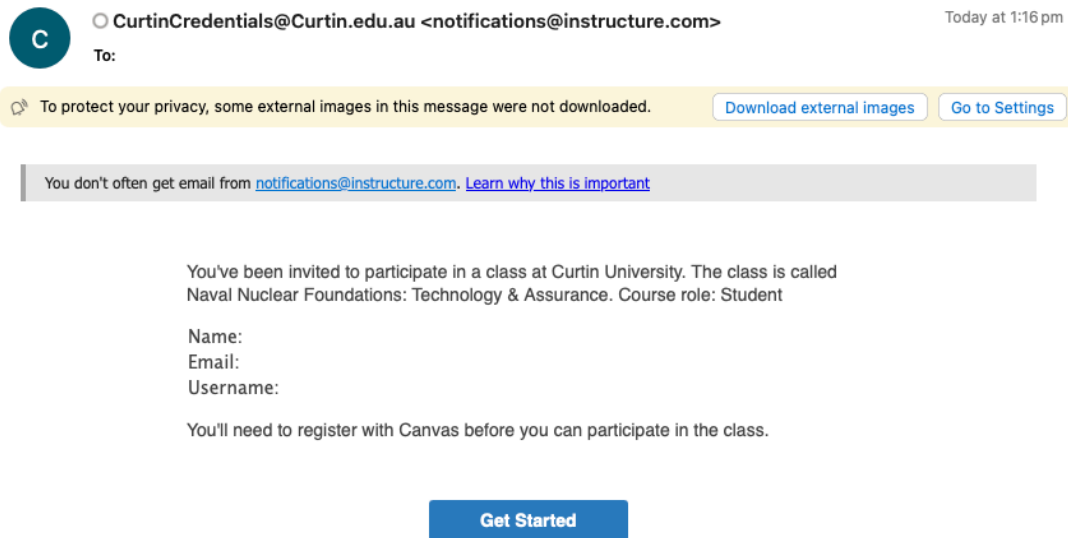
This guide walks you through everything you need to do to set up your Canvas account, from the moment you receive your invitation email to logging in for the first time.

You’ll need two devices: a computer (or the phone you’re reading this on) and a smartphone (iPhone or Android) to install a free authenticator app. The whole process takes about 10 minutes.

STEP 1

You'll receive an email inviting you to join the course in Canvas. It's sent from CurtinCredentials@curtin.edu.au via a system called notifications@instructure.com. Instructure is the company that makes Canvas, so this address is legitimate even though it looks unfamiliar.

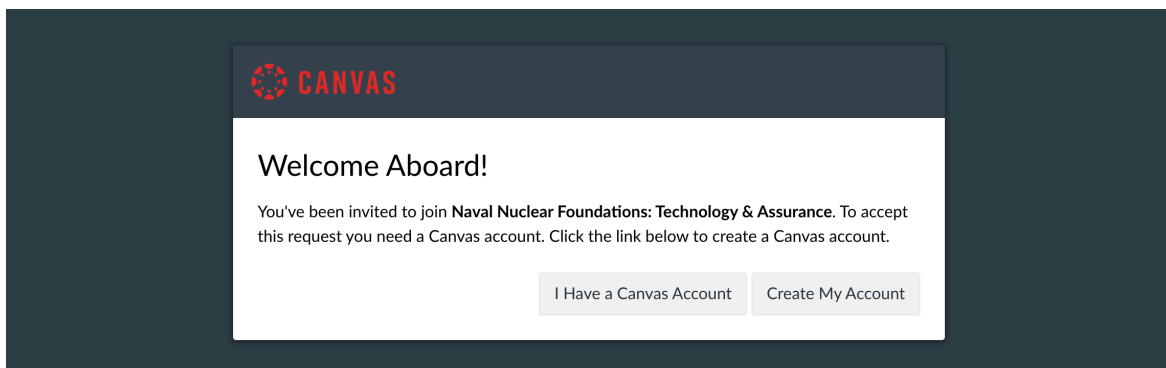
Note: If you can't find the email, check your Junk or Spam folder.
Open the email and click the "Get Started" button.



STEP 2

Clicking the link opens the "Welcome Aboard" page shown below. You'll see two buttons:

- Create My Account: choose this if this is the **first time** you're setting up a Curtin Credentials / Canvas account.
- I Have a Canvas Account: choose this if you've **completed a Curtin Credential** before and already have a login.



Note: The URL at the top of this page is personal to you and should not be shared with anyone else. It's a one-time link to your invitation.

STEP 3

If you selected “Create My Account”, you’ll be asked for your full name, email address, and a password. Complete these details and click the button to continue.

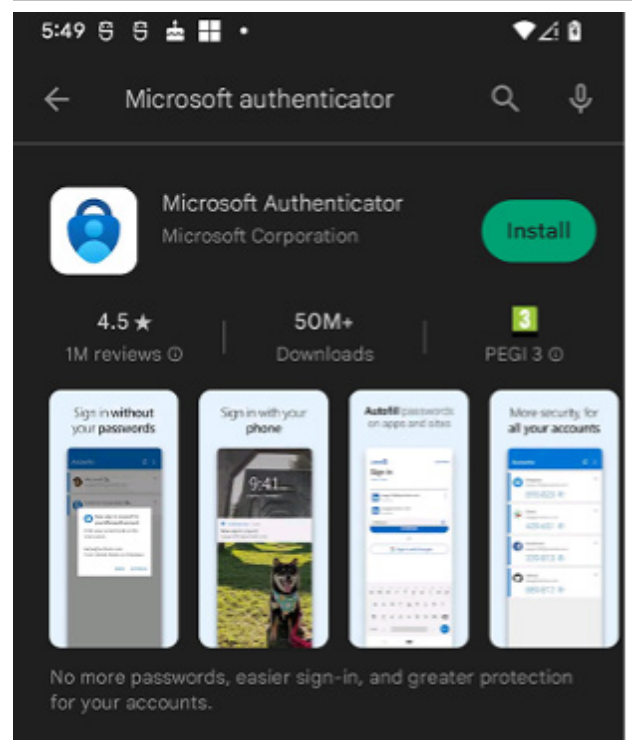
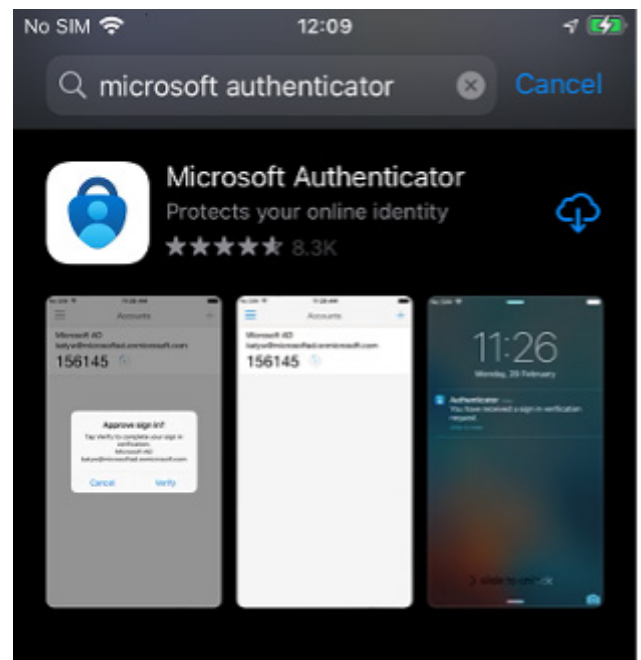
- Use the email address associated with your canvas course. Canvas will send notifications here.
- Choose a password you don’t use anywhere elsewhere.

STEP 4

Install Microsoft Authenticator App

Microsoft Authenticator is a free app that generates the six-digit codes Canvas will ask you for.

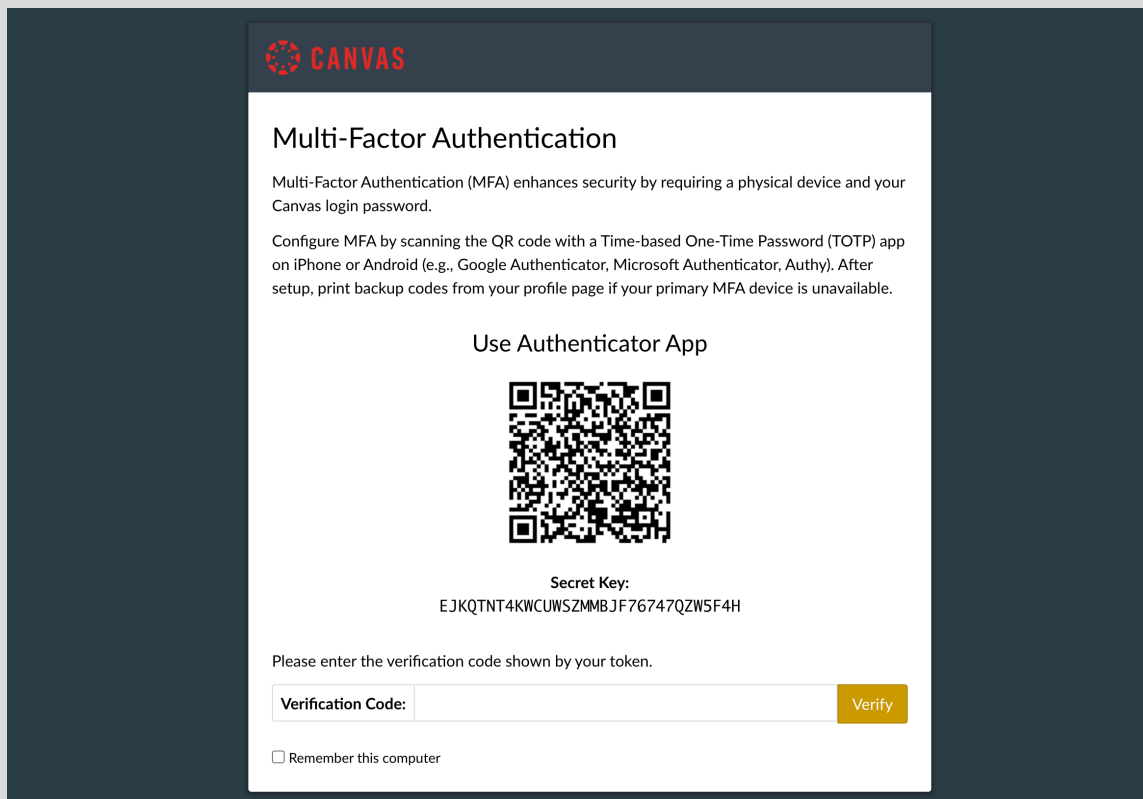
Open the App Store on either your apple or android phone and download “Microsoft Authenticator”.



STEP 4

1. Once installed, open Microsoft Authenticator and press Accept on the first screen.
2. Select your choice of sharing app usage data and press continue
3. IMPORTANT: You do not need to sign in with a microsoft account to successfully complete this process. Press “skip” or “not now” if you do not have an account
4. The app will ask for permission to use your camera. Allow this, it’s needed to scan the QR code in the next step.

STEP 5

The screenshot shows the Canvas Multi-Factor Authentication setup page. At the top is the Canvas logo. The main heading is "Multi-Factor Authentication". Below it, a paragraph explains that MFA enhances security by requiring a physical device and a Canvas login password. Another paragraph instructs users to configure MFA by scanning a QR code with a Time-based One-Time Password (TOTP) app on iPhone or Android (e.g., Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, Authy), and to print backup codes if the primary MFA device is unavailable. The section "Use Authenticator App" features a large QR code. Below the QR code is the "Secret Key: EJKQTNT4KWCUSZMMBJF76747QZW5F4H". A prompt asks the user to enter the verification code shown by their token. There is a text input field labeled "Verification Code:" and a yellow "Verify" button. At the bottom, there is a checkbox labeled "Remember this computer".

CANVAS

Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enhances security by requiring a physical device and your Canvas login password.

Configure MFA by scanning the QR code with a Time-based One-Time Password (TOTP) app on iPhone or Android (e.g., Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, Authy). After setup, print backup codes from your profile page if your primary MFA device is unavailable.

Use Authenticator App



Secret Key:
EJKQTNT4KWCUSZMMBJF76747QZW5F4H

Please enter the verification code shown by your token.

Verification Code: **Verify**

☐ Remember this computer

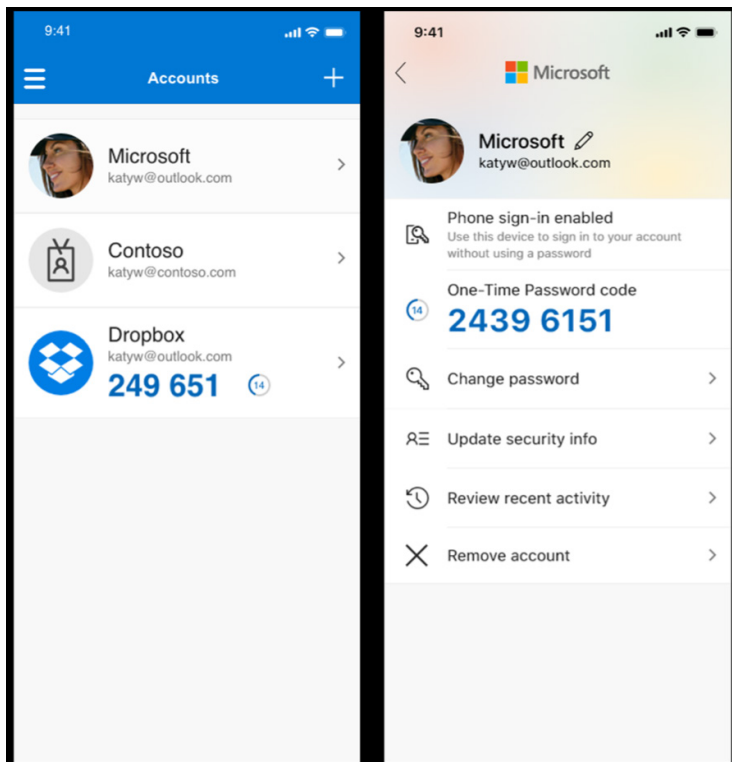
Back in Canvas, you'll now see the Multi-Factor Authentication page with a QR code and a "Secret Key" underneath it (see the example below, the code and key on your screen will be unique to you).

There are two ways to connect the app, depending on which device you're using to view Canvas.

Option 1 (Recommended)

Scanning the QR code (use this if Canvas is open on a computer)

- In Microsoft Authenticator, tap the "+" button (usually top-right) and choose "Add account" > "Other account."
- Point your phone's camera at the QR code on your computer screen until it scans automatically.
- The app will add the account and start showing a six-digit code.



Option 2

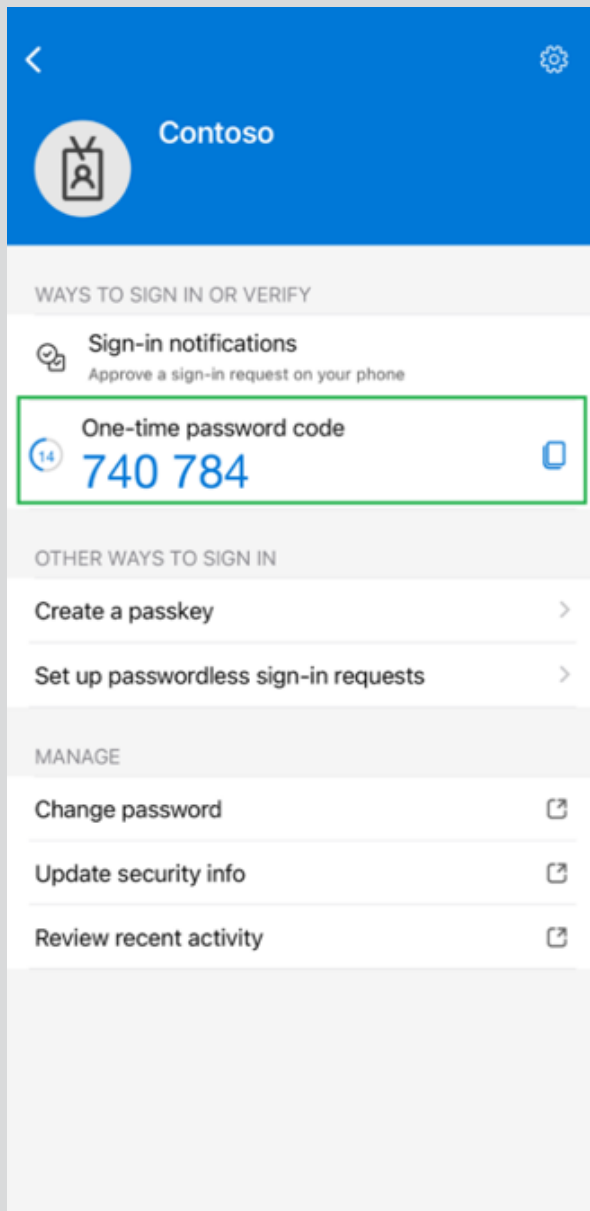
Entering the secret key manually (use this if you only have one device).

If you're doing this whole process on your phone, there's nothing to scan, your camera can't photograph the code on the same screen it's displayed on. Instead:

- In Microsoft Authenticator, tap the "+" button and choose "Add account" > "Other account." Look for an option like "Or enter code manually" / "Enter this instead" underneath the scan screen.
- Type in the Secret Key exactly as shown on the Canvas page (letters and numbers, no spaces). Give the account a name you'll recognise, such as "Canvas," and save.

STEP 6

Once the account is added, Microsoft Authenticator will display a six-digit code for "Canvas." Type this code into the "Verification Code" field on the Canvas page, then click Verify.



! **Note:** The code changes every 30 seconds. If you type it in and Canvas says it's incorrect, just check the app for current code and try again. It may have refreshed while you were typing.



Curtin Credentials



Curtincredentials@curtin.edu.au



creds.curtin.edu.au



Curtin of Learning Enterprise and Partnership Engagement